Mahjong library expansion

Collected using the Codex built-in browser on 7 October 2026. Seven newly downloaded PDFs, 465 pages, plus this original four-page study companion. The original PDFs are preserved. This is a broad selection from multiple websites, not a search of every website or an exhaustive bibliography.

Singapore-first reading order: keep your earlier Singapore rules sheets beside you. Read file 12 for a short strategy overview, file 04 in the previous pack for basic tile efficiency, then file 03 (Riichi Book I). Move to 13 and 16 for deeper study. Read 09 for MCR strategy comparisons. Files 10, 11 and 15 are supplementary rules guides.

Transferring strategy: connected shapes, flexible block assignments and counting visible tiles are useful across ordinary four-sets-and-a-pair hands. Japanese riichi, dora, furiten and fixed safe-tile claims are variant-specific. MCR combinations and British special hands may be ineligible at your Singapore table. Recalculate hand value and payment risk using your actual rules.

Books and notes - first group

09 - World-Class Mahjong with World Champion Mai Hatsune

61 pages | MCR. Mai Hatsune and Takunori Kajimoto; translation by Ryan Morris. Hand patterns, timing calls and strategy examples. Read for alternative approaches to hand value; MCR points do not map directly to Singapore tai.

Original download source

10 - A Guide to Mahjong

38 pages | MCR. Tiles, setup, calls, winning and scoring. A beginner reference distributed by Mahjong International League.

Original download source

11 - A U3A Beginners Guide to Mahjong

30 pages | British. Hilvary Robinson. Step-by-step instruction, quizzes, special hands, glossary and answers. British scoring and special hands differ from Singapore play.

Original download source

Books and notes - deeper strategy

12 - Riichi Mahjong Strategies

38 pages | Riichi. Berlin Mahjong Club lecture slides introducing attack and defense. Use the hand-building lessons first.

Original download source

13 - Intermediate Riichi Strategies

129 pages | Riichi. Feng. Expanded workshop slides assuming familiarity with Riichi Book I and block theory. Best after the beginner strategy books.

Original download source

15 - Hong Kong Mahjong Rules

10 pages | Hong Kong. A compact variant reference hosted by Associazione Italiana Mah Jong. Useful for comparison; confirm Singapore differences separately.

Original download source

16 - Riichi Mahjong Strategy

159 pages | Riichi. Fukuchi Makoto; anonymous community translation. Analytical hand-building and later tactical material. The translator describes additions and omissions, so this is not an official word-for-word edition.

Original download source

Other sources inspected

MahjongSoft / Vitaly Novikov lists MCR books, mahjong mysteries and a Sichuan book. Downloads require payment/donation or verified-user access, so none was obtained. British rules download directory contains playing aids and sample publications. Neither source is a Singapore strategy authority.

The community directory MJG guides supplied links for files 13 and 16. Its linked 50 Shades of Mahjong booklet returned HTTP 404 and was excluded. Titles listed online are not evidence that a file remains downloadable.

Three web lessons: concise study notes

These are short paraphrased summaries with links, not full article reproductions. The sources teach riichi; the Singapore comments below are our adaptations.

1. Starting hands and five-block theory

Rosti, 29 December 2017. Plan an ordinary hand as four sets and a pair. Distinguish finished sets, incomplete candidates and isolated tiles. When a block is missing, retain isolated tiles that have several ways to connect. A hand with five candidates can still benefit from a spare tile that may replace a weak candidate. Do not treat an early discard priority as an absolute rule: scoring potential can change which tiles deserve protection.

Read the original lesson. Singapore adaptation: preserve a realistic minimum-tai route even when it is slower than a purely structural choice.

2. Basic tile efficiency

Rosti, 6 January 2018. Shanten measures steps to a ready hand; ukeire counts tiles that reduce that distance. Two-sided incomplete sequences generally accept more completing tiles than edge or gap waits. A gap shape can sometimes upgrade to a two-sided shape. Pairs have a special role because a normal hand needs a pair. Adjacent tiles may belong to multiple possible blocks, so reassess clusters after each draw. Avoid double-counting improving tiles that serve overlapping candidates.

Read the original lesson. Singapore adaptation: count both structural improvements and whether those improvements leave the hand eligible to win.

3. The tradeoffs in calling

Puyo, translated by garcia1000, 22 July 2017. Calls can make a hand faster by using opponents' discards. They also reduce the number of concealed tiles available for defense and disclose information about the hand. In riichi, calls can additionally reduce scoring opportunities. Judge a call by the speed gained and the flexibility and value lost, rather than taking every available meld.

Read the original lesson. Singapore adaptation: the Japanese closed-hand value penalties do not transfer automatically. Work out the resulting tai, wait and mandatory discard under your table rules.

Original practice sheet and answer notes

The following exercises are original. Numbered shapes are within one suit unless stated otherwise. Copy counts describe possible unseen tiles, not guaranteed wall contents. Assume an ordinary four-sets-and-a-pair hand and that the scoring requirement is already secured unless specified.

Exercise 1 - Compare waits

A: 3-4 Bamboo. B: 3-5 Bamboo. C: 8-9 Bamboo. List the completing ranks and maximum copies before considering visible tiles.

Answer: A completes with 2 or 5 (8 copies). B completes with 4 (4 copies). C completes with 7 (4 copies). A usually provides more immediate possibilities; actual remaining copies and the rest of the hand can change the ranking.

Exercise 2 - Subtract visible tiles

Your final incomplete set is 6-7 Circles. Two 5 Circles are discarded and one 8 Circle is in an exposed meld. How many completing copies are unseen?

Answer: 5 or 8 completes the set. Start with 8, subtract 3 visible copies: 5 unseen. Some can be held by opponents. Count a claimed discard only once, as the same physical tile now in a meld.

Exercise 3 - Keep an overlapping shape flexible

You hold 3-4-5-6 Characters. Identify two ways to organise these tiles. Why might treating the 6 as automatically surplus be a mistake?

Answer: 3-4-5 plus an isolated 6 is one view; 3-4 plus 5-6 is another. The second view preserves two two-sided set candidates. Which view is better depends on your other blocks, pair and scoring route. A completed sequence does not make every neighbouring tile expendable.

Exercise 4 - Test a call

An opponent discards a tile you can Pong. Before calling, write your remaining concealed tiles, next discard, minimum-tai route and final wait. If calling leaves you equally far from a legal win but forces a dangerous discard, what should you reconsider?

Answer: reconsider the call itself. A meld is not automatically progress. Consider any immediate bonus separately, but include lost flexibility and payout risk in the decision.

Review routine

Practise one chapter at a time. Record your reasoning before reading the answer. Review the most costly mistakes using only information visible at the time. Avoid judging a sound decision solely by a lucky or unlucky next draw. Agree table rules before using any imported strategy.